

Sony PlayStation

How Sony entered the console market and the first PlayStation came about to be is an interesting story in itself. Nintendo had been ruling the gaming world for quite some time and Sony signed a deal in 1998 with them to develop a CD drive for their next generation console. Simultaneously Sony started to work on its own console using the same CD drive it was developing. The Japanese company announced its own console dubbed the 'Play Station' at the 1991 Consumer Electronic Show at CES. This console was supposed to be able to run both CD ROMs and Nintendo Cartridges.

Nintendo saw it as betrayal of their trust and went on to announce its partnership with Philips for a disc drive for its next console, scrapping its earlier deal with Sony. This created havoc in the industry. Nintendo could now be facing serious legal action from Sony. But with time everything blew over. Both the companies realised that it was in their mutual benefit to not take any further actions. Nintendo was still using the audio chip manufactured by Sony and Sony was planning to port Nintendo games and cartridges for its own upcoming console.

It was announced in 1992 that the disc drives used by the two companies will be compatible with each other but the software license was given to Nintendo while Sony received minimal licensing royalties.

Sony scrapped its original prototype and went back to the drawing board. They developed a completely new machine minus the cartridge port. The new PlayStation boasted of some impressive hardware unseen at the time but Sony knew this wasn't gonna be enough.



Sony's foray into the console gaming world proved very successful with its first console selling more than 100 million units before it was discontinued.